

Useful Words

For melodies: Scalic, Countermelody, Phrase, Ascending/Descending

Syncopation (can apply to any genre)

Polyrhythm (lots of non-Western music)

Consonant / Dissonant

Ornamented (can apply to lots of non-Western music as well as music from the Baroque period)

Arabic Music

Tonality: Maqām

Metre: Īqā'āt (singular Īqā')

Takht ensemble: Qanun, Riqq, Nay, Ud, Violin

Hindustani Classical Music

Tonality: Rāga

Metre: Tāla

Instruments: Bansuri, Sarangi, Sarod, Sitar, Tabla, Tambura

Structure: ālāp, jōr, gat, jhālā

Chinese Music (Silk and Bamboo)

Tonality: Pentatonic

Instruments: Ban (clapper), Bangzi (woodblock), Dizi, Erhu, Pipa, Sheng, Yangqin

Latin Music

Tango: Orquesta Tipica, Bandoneon

Salsa: Claves, Cuatro (guitar)

Orchestral Instruments

Woodwind: Flute Oboe Clarinet Bassoon

Brass: Horn Trumpet Trombone Tuba

Strings: Violin Viola Cello Contrabass (= Double Bass)

Music Tech

Sample, Loop, Chorus, Reverb, Delay, Overdubbing, Double-tracking, Multi-tracking, Drum Machine

Notation

Alto Clef



Clarinet / Horn rewrites: write the notes at sounding pitch:



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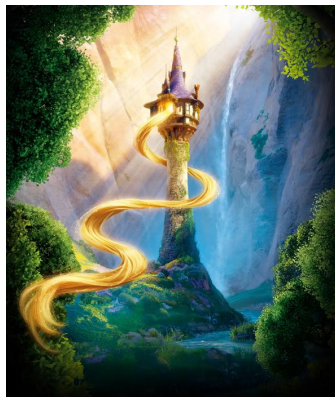
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Pitch

High

Low



Rhythm

short/long note values

syncopated

keeping the pulse

dotted

'Four on the floor'



Timbre

blown

bowed

plucked

struck

brassy

distorted



Melody

ascending
descending
step / leap

repeated
angular

Tempo

Andante
Adagio
Lento / Largo
Allegro
Presto

Metre

Quadruple
Duple
Triple

Irregular

Instruments

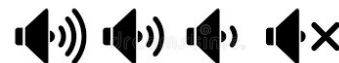
Brass
Strings
Woodwind

Dynamics

Pp
P
Mp
F
Mf
Ff
Crescendo
diminuendo

TWIN-KLE, TWIN-KLE, LIT-TLE STAR, HOW I WON-DER WHAT YOU ARE

TWIN-KLE, TWIN-KLE, LIT-TLE STAR, HOW I WON-DER WHAT YOU ARE



Tonality

Major

Minor

Chromatic

Functional

Diatonic

Jazzy (Added note
harmonies)



Structure

Binary form

Sonata form

Ternary form

Ritornello

Episodes

Verse

Hook

Chorus

Bridge



Texture

Polyphonic

Homophonic

Melody and
Accompaniment

Monophonic

